

We love movies. Action, comedy, drama, thrillers, super-heroes - they all capture our imagination through the wonder that is the moving picture. But how do these works of art (and sometimes farce) capture our attention and emotions? A lot of it of course has to do with the footage, the landscapes, the epic scenes, the close up of emotion, the beat of the music and the timing of the silences but that isn't all. It has to do with how all those elements of story are arranged - and that's where editing comes in to the picture.

Editing is a critical form of storytelling that determines what the audience sees, how it's shown and when the elements find a place. The story is the big outline within which an editor paints with the brush of the footage - a cut here, a beat there - and presto you have a cinematic moment. The worst of films have been salvaged from the pits thanks to talented editors. In order to learn the skills of good editing the most important thing for anyone to do is to learn to tell stories with pictures and then begin understanding how all the rest is placed. We will use this chapter to break down the technical and artistic process that goes into telling a good story and what you as an editor can do to make sure every project you work on is great.

## Multimedia Editing: Video, Audio, Image and Everything

Multimedia editing as we've covered in the early chapters is the broad spectrum of media types - audio, video, animation, graphics, animation, text - being placed in the right order to tell an interesting story. The same collection of media files can be rearranged with different tunings to give the story a completely different feeling. This is why understanding the strengths and shortcomings of different media formats becomes critical. The way each of them is used also underscores what aspect of the story you as an editor are trying to draw attention to or away as the case may be.

Video footage is the primary material with which any editor works, after all it is the main element of any movie. But while shooting you will find that you may have many different angles, distances and styles to how

